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Stakeholder Mapping Template

Identifying Influence, Coverage Gaps, and Champions Across the Buying Group

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Stakeholder Mapping Template

Building Strategic Relationships That Drive Customer Success

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Introduction

"Products don't buy products. Companies don't buy products. People do. And people make decisions based on trust, influence, priorities, and relationships."

One of the most common reasons customer accounts become vulnerable isn't because the product stopped delivering value---it is because the Customer Success team built their entire relationship around one individual.

That individual becomes the champion, attends every meeting, responds to every email, and advocates internally for the solution. Everything appears healthy until one unexpected event changes the account forever.

They resign.

They are promoted.

They move to another department.

They leave the company.

Suddenly, the relationship disappears overnight.

This scenario happens every day across Customer Success organizations, and the consequences can be severe. Projects lose momentum, executive sponsorship fades, product adoption declines, renewal conversations stall, and competitors seize the opportunity to position themselves as a safer choice.

A Stakeholder Map exists to prevent this situation.

Rather than relying on a single point of contact, Stakeholder Mapping provides a structured understanding of everyone involved in the customer's organization. It identifies decision makers, executive sponsors, daily users, influencers, technical teams, champions, potential blockers, and individuals who may become important later in the customer journey.

More importantly, it reveals where your relationships are strong, where they are weak, and where they do not exist at all.

Customer Success is rarely about managing a product.

It is about managing relationships that enable customers to achieve their business outcomes.

A well-maintained Stakeholder Map ensures that knowledge, influence, and trust are distributed across the account instead of concentrated in one person. It allows Customer Success Managers to anticipate organizational changes, engage the right people at the right time, and reduce the risk associated with stakeholder turnover.

The strongest Customer Success teams do not ask, "Who is our contact?"

They ask, "Who influences success inside this organization, and how well do we know them?"

That mindset transforms Stakeholder Mapping from an administrative exercise into a strategic advantage.

Chapter 1

Why Stakeholder Mapping Matters

Every customer account is a network of people with different goals, responsibilities, priorities, and levels of influence. While they may all belong to the same organization, they rarely evaluate success through the same lens.

An executive sponsor may focus on return on investment and strategic outcomes.

An operations manager may prioritize efficiency and workflow improvements.

An IT administrator may care about system reliability, security, and integration.

End users simply want a solution that makes their daily work easier.

If a Customer Success Manager only builds a relationship with one of these stakeholders, they gain an incomplete picture of the account. Decisions begin to rely on second-hand information, assumptions replace direct conversations, and important changes within the organization often go unnoticed until they create problems.

Stakeholder Mapping addresses this challenge by providing a structured view of everyone who can influence the success of the partnership.

It helps Customer Success Managers answer critical questions such as:

- Who has the authority to approve renewals?
- Who influences executive decisions?
- Who uses the product every day?
- Who may resist change?
- Which departments have not yet been engaged?
- If our champion leaves tomorrow, who else knows the value we > deliver?

The answers to these questions determine how resilient an account truly is.

A healthy account is not measured only by product adoption or customer satisfaction. It is also measured by the strength and diversity of the relationships supporting it.

Consider a SaaS company providing workflow automation software to a large financial institution. The Customer Success Manager works closely with the Operations Manager, who champions the solution internally and consistently advocates for additional adoption. Six months before renewal, the Operations Manager accepts a role at another organization.

Without a Stakeholder Map, the Customer Success Manager suddenly has no direct relationship with executive leadership, finance, or the IT department. Renewal conversations become difficult because the individuals responsible for approving the budget have never personally experienced the value delivered by the solution.

Now consider the same scenario with an actively maintained Stakeholder Map.

Because relationships had already been established with the Chief Operations Officer, IT Director, Finance Manager, and department supervisors, the departure of the champion created only a temporary disruption rather than a business risk. The Customer Success Manager quickly engaged existing stakeholders, ensured continuity, and maintained momentum toward renewal.

The product did not change.

The customer did not change.

The difference was relationship resilience.

This is why Stakeholder Mapping is not simply about documenting names and job titles. It is about understanding influence, building trust across the organization, and ensuring that customer success is never dependent on a single relationship.

For Customer Success Managers, every meaningful relationship reduces risk. Every new stakeholder increases visibility. Every gap represents an opportunity to strengthen the partnership before it becomes a problem.

Chapter 2

Understanding Organizational Influence

Every organization operates through formal structures and informal networks. While an organizational chart may show reporting lines and job titles, it rarely reveals who truly influences decisions.

One of the biggest misconceptions in Customer Success is assuming that the person with the highest title has the greatest influence over the success of an account. In reality, influence often comes from credibility, relationships, expertise, and trust rather than position alone.

A Chief Executive Officer may approve the budget, but an Operations Manager might determine whether the solution is adopted successfully. An IT Manager may not control spending, yet their opinion could significantly influence implementation decisions. Similarly, a department supervisor may become the strongest advocate for expansion because they experience the product's value every day.

Understanding these dynamics helps Customer Success Managers engage stakeholders more effectively. Instead of communicating with everyone in the same way, conversations can be tailored to each stakeholder's priorities.

Executives typically focus on strategic outcomes such as return on investment, business growth, operational efficiency, and risk reduction. Managers are often concerned with process improvements, productivity, and achieving departmental objectives. Technical teams prioritize security, integrations, reliability, and system performance. End users simply want a product that helps them complete their work more efficiently.

Recognizing these different perspectives allows Customer Success Managers to communicate value in a way that resonates with each audience.

Influence also changes over time. During implementation, technical stakeholders often play a dominant role. As adoption increases, operational leaders become more influential. Near renewal, executive sponsors and procurement teams usually become the primary decision-makers.

Stakeholder Mapping should therefore reflect not only who matters today but also who is likely to become important at different stages of the customer lifecycle.

Chapter 3

When Stakeholder Mapping Should Be Created

Stakeholder Mapping should begin during the Discovery stage and continue evolving throughout the customer lifecycle.

Waiting until onboarding is complete often means valuable opportunities to build relationships have already been missed.

During Discovery, Customer Success Managers should identify every individual who may influence implementation, adoption, business outcomes, renewal, or expansion. At this stage, the objective is not to create a perfect map but to establish a strong foundation that can be refined over time.

The Stakeholder Map should be reviewed and updated during several key moments.

Discovery

Identify decision-makers, executive sponsors, project owners, technical contacts, and end users.

Onboarding

Validate stakeholder roles and identify additional participants who emerge during implementation.

Adoption

Monitor engagement levels and identify new champions or potential blockers.

Executive Business Reviews

Confirm that the right executives continue to participate and verify whether business priorities have changed.

Renewal Planning

Ensure decision-makers and procurement contacts are accurately documented before commercial discussions begin.

Organizational Changes

Whenever a stakeholder changes roles or leaves the company, immediately review and update the Stakeholder Map.

Organizations are constantly evolving. Promotions, restructures, mergers, acquisitions, and employee turnover can significantly alter account dynamics.

A Stakeholder Map that is six months old but never updated may be less useful than no Stakeholder Map at all.

Chapter 4

The Stakeholder Mapping Framework

An effective Stakeholder Map follows a structured framework that enables Customer Success Managers to understand not only who stakeholders are but also how they influence the success of the account.

The framework consists of six key components.

Component One: Identification

Document every stakeholder connected to the customer relationship.

Include names, job titles, departments, and primary responsibilities.

Do not limit the map to people who attend meetings. Many influential stakeholders rarely participate directly but still affect key decisions.

Component Two: Influence Assessment

Evaluate how much influence each stakeholder has over implementation, adoption, renewal, and expansion.

Classify influence as:

High

Medium

Low

Remember that influence is contextual. A technical administrator may have greater influence during implementation than an executive sponsor.

Component Three: Interest Level

Determine how invested each stakeholder is in the project's success.

Some stakeholders care deeply because the solution directly affects their daily work.

Others may only become involved during executive reviews or budget discussions.

Understanding interest levels helps prioritize engagement.

Component Four: Relationship Strength

Assess your current relationship.

Strong

Developing

Limited

No Relationship

This reveals where additional relationship-building efforts are needed.

Component Five: Stakeholder Classification

Categorize stakeholders according to their role within the customer journey.

Executive Sponsor

Decision Maker

Champion

Influencer

Technical Lead
Project Manager
End User
Procurement
Potential Blocker

Each classification helps shape engagement strategies.

Component Six: Engagement Strategy

Every stakeholder should have a documented engagement approach.

Questions to consider include:

How often should they be contacted?

What information matters most to them?

Which meetings should they attend?

How do they define success?

A Stakeholder Map becomes significantly more valuable when it moves beyond documentation and actively guides communication.

Chapter 5

Building the Stakeholder Map Step-by-Step

Creating a Stakeholder Map is a continuous process rather than a one-time activity.

The following six-step approach provides a practical framework.

Step One

Collect stakeholder information during Discovery.

Record every individual mentioned during conversations, regardless of their current level of involvement.

Step Two

Understand reporting relationships.

Determine who reports to whom and identify formal decision-making structures.

This helps explain how influence flows throughout the organization.

Step Three

Identify informal influencers.

Some individuals have significant credibility despite holding relatively junior positions.

Do not overlook these hidden influencers.

Step Four

Evaluate relationship strength.

Ask yourself:

How well do we know this stakeholder?

Have we met them directly?

Have they experienced value from our solution?

Would they advocate for us internally?

Step Five

Identify relationship gaps.

Which departments have not been engaged?

Which executives have never attended a review?

Who could become a future champion?

These questions reveal opportunities for proactive engagement.

Step Six

Review and maintain the map.

A Stakeholder Map should be updated after every major customer interaction.

Treat it as a living document rather than static account documentation.

Chapter 6

Identifying Key Stakeholders

Not every stakeholder contributes to the customer journey in the same way. Understanding each person's role allows Customer Success Managers to communicate more effectively and build stronger relationships across the organization.

Executive Sponsor

Provides strategic direction, executive alignment, and organizational support.

Typically evaluates business outcomes and return on investment.

Economic Buyer

Controls budgets and approves commercial decisions.

Usually becomes heavily involved during renewals and expansions.

Decision Maker

Authorizes major project decisions and determines whether initiatives proceed.

May or may not control the budget.

Project Manager

Coordinates implementation activities and ensures milestones remain on schedule.

Acts as the operational link between the customer and vendor teams.

Technical Lead

Responsible for integrations, system configuration, security, and technical readiness.

Frequently involved during implementation and optimization.

Champion

Believes strongly in the solution and actively promotes it within the organization.

Champions accelerate adoption and influence internal decision-making.

However, Customer Success Managers should avoid relying exclusively on one champion.

End Users

Use the product daily.

Their experience directly influences adoption, customer satisfaction, and long-term value realization.

Procurement

Supports commercial negotiations and contract management.

Usually becomes engaged near renewal.

Maintaining early relationships with procurement teams can simplify future negotiations.

Chapter 7

Power vs. Interest Matrix

One of the most effective ways to prioritize stakeholder engagement is through a Power versus Interest Matrix.

Rather than giving equal attention to every stakeholder, the matrix helps Customer Success Managers allocate time where it creates the greatest business impact.

The matrix divides stakeholders into four categories.

High Power -- High Interest

These stakeholders require close collaboration.

Examples include executive sponsors, business owners, and primary decision-makers.

Engagement Strategy:

Schedule regular meetings.

Provide strategic updates.

Share measurable business outcomes.

Involve them in Executive Business Reviews.

High Power -- Low Interest

These stakeholders have authority but limited day-to-day involvement.

Examples often include finance executives or senior leadership.

Engagement Strategy:

Keep communication concise.

Focus on business value.

Avoid unnecessary operational details.

Low Power -- High Interest

These stakeholders actively use the product and often become valuable champions.

Examples include department managers, team leaders, and power users.

Engagement Strategy:

Provide training.

Encourage feedback.

Recognize achievements.

Support adoption initiatives.

Low Power -- Low Interest

These stakeholders require minimal engagement but should still remain visible within the Stakeholder Map.

Monitor changes in their responsibilities, as influence levels may increase over time.

Practical Example

Consider a logistics company implementing route optimization software.

The Chief Operations Officer has high power and high interest because operational efficiency directly affects business performance.

The Finance Director has high power but low interest, becoming involved mainly during budget reviews.

Warehouse supervisors have low organizational power but high interest because they use the system daily and influence employee adoption.

Administrative staff have low power and low interest, requiring only periodic communication.

By tailoring engagement strategies to each stakeholder group, Customer Success Managers improve communication efficiency, strengthen relationships, and reduce the risk of overlooking influential individuals.

The objective of the Power versus Interest Matrix is not to prioritize people based on importance but to prioritize engagement based on influence and business impact.

Chapter 8

Champion, Blocker & Neutral Analysis

Every stakeholder influences the success of a customer relationship differently. Some actively advocate for your solution, others resist change, while many remain undecided until they see measurable results. Understanding these behavioral patterns allows Customer Success Managers to engage stakeholders more strategically rather than treating every relationship the same.

Stakeholders generally fall into three categories.

Champions

Champions are your strongest internal advocates. They believe in the value of your solution, promote it within their organization, encourage adoption, and often defend the investment when challenges arise.

Characteristics of a Champion include:

- Actively participates in meetings.
- Responds promptly to communication.
- Shares product successes internally.
- Encourages colleagues to adopt the solution.
- Provides honest feedback to improve the partnership.

Champions should be empowered rather than overburdened. Provide them with success stories, business metrics, executive summaries, and resources they can easily share with leadership. Their credibility often carries more influence than anything presented by the vendor.

However, no Customer Success strategy should rely on a single champion. Champions can change roles, leave the organization, or shift priorities. Always build relationships beyond your primary advocate.

Blockers

Blockers are stakeholders who intentionally or unintentionally slow progress.

A blocker is not necessarily someone who dislikes your solution. They may simply have competing priorities, concerns about change, limited resources, or previous negative experiences.

Common signs of blockers include:

- Repeatedly delaying decisions.
- Avoiding meetings.
- Questioning implementation timelines.
- Raising objections without proposing alternatives.
- Showing limited engagement despite repeated outreach.

The goal is not to confront blockers but to understand the reasons behind their concerns. Many blockers become strong supporters once their challenges are acknowledged and addressed.

Customer Success Managers should approach blockers with curiosity rather than defensiveness.

Neutral Stakeholders

Neutral stakeholders neither actively support nor oppose the project.

They often become influential later in the customer lifecycle, particularly during renewal or expansion discussions.

Examples include:

Finance Managers

Compliance Teams

Department Supervisors

Regional Managers

Although neutral today, these stakeholders represent future opportunities for relationship building.

Regular communication ensures they remain informed and prepared should their involvement increase.

Chapter 9

Relationship Coverage & Gap Analysis

A Stakeholder Map is only valuable if it reveals where relationships are missing.

Relationship Coverage measures how well your Customer Success team is connected across the customer's organization.

Strong coverage means relationships exist across executive leadership, operational management, technical teams, project leadership, procurement, and end users.

Weak coverage occurs when communication depends heavily on one or two individuals.

Conducting a Gap Analysis helps identify where additional engagement is required before those gaps become business risks.

Questions to ask include:

- Which departments have never attended a review meeting?
- Which executives have never seen the business outcomes achieved?
- Are procurement and finance engaged before renewal?
- Have technical stakeholders participated since implementation?
- If our primary champion resigned tomorrow, who else understands our value?

These questions expose vulnerabilities that traditional health scores often overlook.

Practical Scenario

A Customer Success Manager supporting a healthcare software provider maintained an excellent relationship with the Director of Nursing. Product adoption remained high and satisfaction scores were positive.

However, the Chief Financial Officer had never attended a Quarterly Business Review, and Procurement had limited visibility into the business value delivered.

When budget reductions were announced, the renewal was questioned because financial stakeholders had never personally seen the operational improvements achieved.

Had relationship gaps been identified earlier, executive engagement could have been strengthened well before renewal discussions.

Relationship coverage is not measured by the number of contacts in your CRM.

It is measured by the quality, diversity, and resilience of the relationships supporting the account.

Chapter 10

Stakeholder Engagement Strategy

Every stakeholder requires a different communication approach.

Sending the same updates to every contact often leads to disengagement because each stakeholder evaluates success differently.

A Stakeholder Engagement Strategy ensures communication is relevant, timely, and valuable.

Executive Sponsors

Primary Interest:

Business outcomes.

Recommended Communication:

Quarterly Executive Business Reviews.

Strategic summaries.

Return on investment.

Business risks.

Future opportunities.

Project Managers

Primary Interest:

Implementation progress.

Recommended Communication:

Weekly project meetings.

Milestone tracking.

Risk updates.

Action items.

Technical Teams

Primary Interest:

System reliability.

Integrations.

Security.

Performance.

Recommended Communication:

Technical workshops.

Release updates.

Integration reviews.

Issue resolution.

Department Managers

Primary Interest:

Operational efficiency.

Team productivity.

User adoption.

Recommended Communication:

Monthly health reviews.

Training updates.

Adoption reports.

Success stories.

End Users

Primary Interest:

Ease of use.

Support.

Training.

Product improvements.

Recommended Communication:

Training sessions.

Knowledge articles.

Feedback surveys.

Feature announcements.

Procurement

Primary Interest:

Commercial terms.

Contract compliance.

Renewal timelines.

Recommended Communication:

Renewal planning meetings.

Contract updates.

Commercial discussions.

By tailoring engagement strategies to stakeholder priorities, Customer Success Managers improve trust, increase participation, and strengthen long-term partnerships.

Chapter 11

Communication Cadence

Strong stakeholder relationships are built through consistency rather than frequency.

Communicating too little creates uncertainty.

Communicating too often with irrelevant information creates fatigue.

The objective is to provide the right information to the right stakeholder at the right time.

A recommended communication cadence includes:

Weekly

Implementation meetings with project teams.

Review completed milestones.

Discuss current risks.

Confirm upcoming activities.

Monthly

Customer Health Reviews.

Review adoption metrics.

Assess customer sentiment.

Identify emerging risks.

Celebrate progress.

Quarterly

Executive Business Reviews.

Present measurable business outcomes.

Review strategic objectives.

Discuss future priorities.

Identify expansion opportunities.

Annually

Strategic Planning Session.

Review long-term business objectives.

Evaluate partnership performance.

Align future initiatives.

Discuss roadmap alignment.

Every meeting should conclude with clearly documented action items, ownership, and agreed timelines.

Consistency builds confidence.

Chapter 12

Maintaining an Accurate Stakeholder Map

A Stakeholder Map should never be considered complete.

Organizations constantly evolve.

Employees receive promotions.

Departments restructure.

Leadership priorities shift.

New initiatives emerge.

Customer Success Managers should therefore review Stakeholder Maps regularly to ensure they continue reflecting the current reality of the customer's organization.

The Stakeholder Map should always be updated after:

- Discovery sessions.
- Implementation milestones.
- Executive Business Reviews.
- Renewal planning meetings.
- Organizational restructures.
- Stakeholder departures.
- New executive appointments.
- Expansion into new departments.

Waiting until renewal to update stakeholder information often results in missed opportunities and unnecessary risk.

Maintaining an accurate Stakeholder Map also improves collaboration across internal teams.

Sales, Professional Services, Support, Product, and Customer Success all benefit from having a shared understanding of customer relationships.

An accurate map enables faster onboarding of new Customer Success Managers, smoother account transitions, and more informed executive conversations.

The map should remain a living document throughout the customer lifecycle.

Chapter 13

Real World Case Study

DigitalWinch

DigitalWinch, a growing technology company, partnered with our Customer Success team to improve customer onboarding and operational efficiency as its customer base expanded rapidly.

During the initial Discovery phase, the relationship centred almost entirely around the Head of Customer Operations, who served as both the executive sponsor and day-to-day project champion. While implementation progressed successfully, our Stakeholder Mapping exercise revealed limited engagement with Product, Engineering, Finance, and Executive Leadership.

Recognizing this as a potential risk, we intentionally expanded our stakeholder engagement strategy.

Monthly operational reviews were introduced with department managers, quarterly Executive Business Reviews included senior leadership, and technical workshops brought Engineering and Product teams into implementation discussions. Procurement and Finance were also engaged well before renewal planning to ensure commercial alignment.

Several months later, the original project champion accepted a leadership role at another organization.

Ordinarily, this type of transition could have disrupted the customer relationship significantly.

Instead, the account remained stable because relationships had already been established across multiple departments. Executive sponsorship continued uninterrupted, operational managers maintained adoption initiatives, technical teams remained engaged, and renewal planning proceeded without delays.

The outcome reinforced an important lesson.

Strong products create value.

Strong relationships protect that value.

A well-maintained Stakeholder Map ensured that the partnership was resilient enough to withstand organizational change without compromising customer success.

Chapter 14

Fully Completed Stakeholder Map

The following example demonstrates what a completed Stakeholder Map could look like after the Discovery phase. While every organization will have different stakeholders and reporting structures, the objective remains the same: understand who influences success, how strong your relationships are, and where engagement should be strengthened.

Customer Information

Customer Name: DigitalWinch

Industry: Technology

Customer Success Manager: David Maika

Executive Sponsor: Amanda Lewis (Chief Operating Officer)

Primary Champion: Daniel Roberts (Head of Customer Operations)

Renewal Date: November 15, 2026

Stakeholder Register

Stakeholder	Role	Department	Power	Interest	Classification	Relationship
Amanda Lewis	Chief Executive Officer	Executive	High	High	Executive Sponsor	Strong Operating
Daniel Roberts	Head of Operations	Operations	High	High	Champion	Strong Customer
Grace Mitchell	Product Manager	Product	Medium	High	Influencer	Developing
Samuel Johnson	IT Manager	Technology	Medium	Medium	Technical Lead	Strong
Linda Carter	Finance	Finance	High	Low	Economic Buyer	Limited
Paul Harris	Procurement	Procurement	High	Low	Decision Maker	Limited
Michelle Adams	Training Lead	Operations	Low	High	End User Advocate	Developing
James Walker	Support	Customer Support	Low	High	Influencer	Strong Supervisor

Stakeholder Analysis

Executive Sponsor

Amanda Lewis oversees the strategic success of the initiative and evaluates business outcomes during Executive Business Reviews. Communication should remain focused on measurable business impact, operational improvements, and return on investment.

Champion

Daniel Roberts manages day-to-day implementation activities and actively promotes product adoption throughout the organization. Regular collaboration with the Champion ensures implementation remains aligned with customer objectives.

Economic Buyer

Linda Carter becomes increasingly influential during budget planning and renewal discussions. Relationship strength should be improved through quarterly business updates demonstrating measurable financial value.

Procurement

Paul Harris is responsible for commercial approvals and contract negotiations. Early engagement before renewal reduces unnecessary delays and commercial surprises.

Technical Lead

Samuel Johnson manages integrations, system performance, and technical readiness. Monthly technical reviews help maintain alignment throughout implementation and optimization.

Relationship Coverage Assessment

Department Relationship Status

Executive Leadership Strong

Operations Strong

Technology Strong

Finance Limited

Procurement Limited

Customer Support Strong

Product Developing

Overall Coverage Assessment:

Good coverage across operational and technical teams.

Additional relationship-building required with Finance and Procurement before renewal.

Engagement Priorities

Immediate Priority

Strengthen relationships with Finance and Procurement.

Medium Priority

Increase Product team involvement during Quarterly Business Reviews.

Ongoing Priority

Maintain executive engagement through business outcome reporting.

Account Risk Assessment

Current Risk Level:

Low

Primary Risk:

Limited commercial relationships outside operational teams.

Mitigation Strategy:

Schedule executive alignment meeting with Finance before renewal planning begins.

Chapter 15

Common Mistakes

Stakeholder Mapping is one of the most valuable strategic tools in Customer Success, yet it is often underutilized because organizations treat it as a one-time administrative exercise rather than an evolving relationship strategy.

One of the most common mistakes is relying too heavily on a single champion. While champions play an essential role in driving adoption and advocating internally, no customer relationship should depend entirely on one individual. Employee turnover, promotions, and organizational restructuring happen frequently. Building relationships across multiple departments protects the partnership against these inevitable changes.

Another mistake is confusing job titles with influence. Formal authority does not always translate into practical decision-making power. Many organizations rely heavily on operational leaders, technical specialists, or experienced managers whose recommendations carry significant weight despite holding relatively junior positions.

Customer Success Managers also make the mistake of engaging stakeholders only when they need something. Relationships built solely around renewals or escalations often feel transactional. Consistent engagement throughout the customer lifecycle creates trust long before important business decisions arise.

Failing to update Stakeholder Maps regularly is another common issue. Organizations change constantly, and outdated stakeholder information creates blind spots that weaken account management.

Finally, many teams overlook departments such as Procurement, Finance, Compliance, and Legal until late in the customer lifecycle. Early engagement with these stakeholders reduces commercial risk and improves renewal planning.

Successful Stakeholder Mapping is not measured by how many names appear on the document.

It is measured by the quality, depth, and resilience of the relationships supporting customer success.

Chapter 16

AI Workflow for Stakeholder Mapping

Artificial Intelligence can significantly improve the efficiency of Stakeholder Mapping by organizing information, identifying relationship patterns, and highlighting engagement opportunities. However, it should support—not replace—the judgment of the Customer Success Manager.

Following Discovery meetings, AI can summarize meeting transcripts and identify every stakeholder mentioned during the conversation. It can extract names, job titles, departments, responsibilities, and action items, allowing Customer Success Managers to build an initial stakeholder register within minutes.

AI can also analyze email conversations, meeting notes, and CRM activity to identify communication frequency and engagement levels. This provides valuable insight into which stakeholders are highly engaged and which relationships require additional attention.

Another practical application is relationship analysis. AI can compare meeting participation over time, highlight declining executive engagement, and identify departments that have not participated in recent customer interactions. These insights help Customer Success Managers address relationship gaps before they become renewal risks.

During Executive Business Review preparation, AI can generate stakeholder summaries outlining each individual's priorities, previous concerns, recent interactions, and recommended discussion points. This enables more personalized conversations and demonstrates a deeper understanding of the customer's organization.

Despite these advantages, AI cannot fully understand organizational politics, interpersonal trust, or informal influence. Customer Success Managers must continue validating stakeholder relationships through direct conversations, observation, and experience.

The strongest Stakeholder Maps combine AI-generated efficiency with human relationship intelligence.

Chapter 17

Best Practices

Begin Stakeholder Mapping during the Discovery phase and continue updating it throughout the customer lifecycle.

Never rely on a single champion, regardless of how engaged they appear. Build relationships across executive leadership, operational teams, technical departments, finance, procurement, and end users.

Review the Stakeholder Map before every Executive Business Review, renewal discussion, and major implementation milestone. This ensures engagement strategies remain aligned with current organizational structures.

Tailor communication to stakeholder priorities rather than distributing identical updates to everyone. Executives require strategic business outcomes, technical teams need implementation details, and end users benefit from practical enablement resources.

Monitor relationship strength as carefully as product adoption. Healthy customer relationships are built on trust, consistency, and meaningful engagement rather than meeting frequency alone.

Document stakeholder changes immediately whenever individuals join, leave, or change roles. Organizational changes often create both risks and opportunities for Customer Success teams.

Finally, remember that Stakeholder Mapping is not simply about recording contacts. It is about understanding influence, reducing account risk, and ensuring the customer relationship remains strong regardless of organizational change.

Chapter 18

Final Template

Customer Information

Customer Name:
Industry:
Customer Success Manager:
Executive Sponsor:
Primary Champion:
Renewal Date:

Stakeholder Register

Name	Job	Department	Power	Interest	Classification	Relationship	Title
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Power vs. Interest Assessment

Stakeholder Power Interest Engagement Strategy

Champion, Blocker & Neutral Analysis

Champions

-

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Blockers

-

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Neutral Stakeholders

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Relationship Coverage

Department Relationship Status Notes

Executive

Operations

Technology

Finance

Procurement

Product

Relationship Gaps

Department:

Current Gap:

Recommended Action:

Owner:

Target Date:

Communication Plan

Stakeholder Meeting Type Frequency

Executive Sponsor Executive Business Review Quarterly

Champion Health Review Monthly

Technical Lead Technical Review Monthly

Procurement Commercial Review Renewal Cycle

Review Schedule

Last Updated:

Next Review Date:

Owner:

Conclusion

Stakeholder Mapping is far more than a contact list. It is a strategic framework for understanding the people who influence customer success and ensuring that no account depends on a single relationship.

When maintained consistently, it helps Customer Success Managers identify champions, engage decision-makers, reduce organizational risk, and strengthen partnerships across every stage of the customer lifecycle. It transforms relationship management from a reactive activity into a proactive strategy that supports implementation, adoption, renewal, and long-term growth.

The strongest Customer Success professionals don't just know who their customers are.

They know who shapes decisions, who drives adoption, who influences change, and how every relationship contributes to delivering lasting customer outcomes.

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About the Author

David Maika is a Customer Success professional with experience spanning customer operations, process improvement, CRM implementation, project management, and business strategy. His work focuses on helping organizations improve customer outcomes, strengthen operational efficiency, and build scalable systems that support long-term growth.

Through practical frameworks, real-world case studies, and modern AI-assisted workflows, he aims to make Customer Success knowledge accessible, actionable, and valuable for professionals at every stage of their careers.

To learn more, access additional resources, or connect professionally, visit davidmaika.com or linkedin.com/in/davidmaika.

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